

Consider the task of making a dot on a paper with a sketch pen. Now the size of the dot will depend on the length of time you keep the sketch pen in contact with the paper (shutter speed), the size of the tip of the pen (aperture), as well as the absorbing power of the paper (ISO speed). Sum up all these factors and you get the net “exposure” that your paper had with the sketch pen. All of these are valid for both, digital and analogue cameras. Now, let’s get into a little more detail about these.

Aperture

Aperture refers to the lens diaphragm opening inside a photographic lens, and aperture range in a camera lens regulates how much the lens can open or close down; hence it controls the amount of light that passes through. Values of aperture openings are represented in terms of “f-stops”, that you must have seen mentioned many times as f2.6, f5.8, f22 etc, These numbers quantitatively describe relative light gathering area, so remember that smaller this value, wider will be the opening. “Faster” lenses are those with larger aperture as for given values of ISO speed, the shutter speed can be made faster here for the same exposure. On the other hand, a smaller aperture will give better depth of field, meaning that objects over a wider range of distance can be in focus. To decide upon the required f-number for your use, you should have a good idea of the surroundings, subjects and desired look of the images captured.

For instance, large apertures with narrower depth of field or faster shutter speeds are preferred for portrait or indoor theatre or sports photography which allow you to isolate the subject from the background. Say you want to shoot night or low-light photography, lenses with larger maximum apertures

Sun Stars
being formed
at f/22



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